

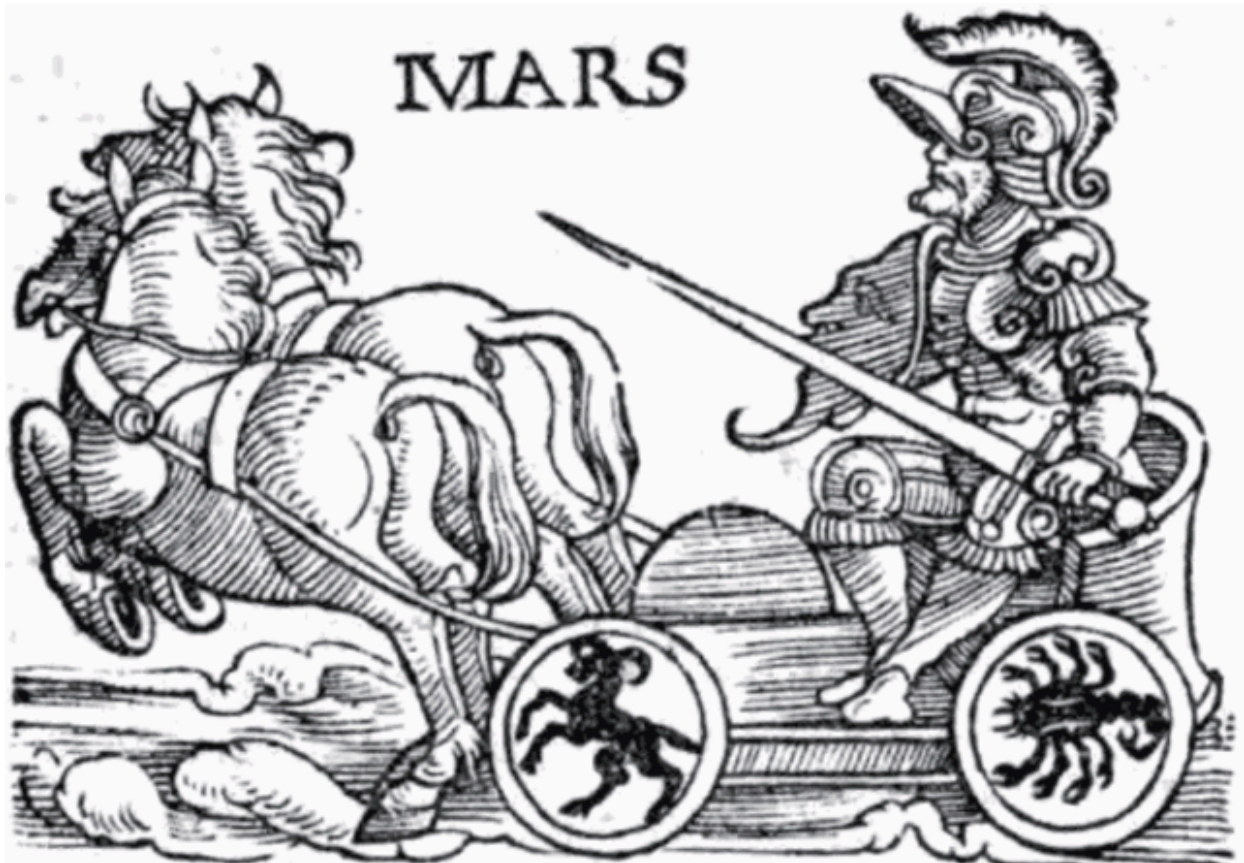


The Warlock

The Book of Thrones

The Warlock's Codex for Seven-Part Pact

Draft 4.26.04 (April 2026)



Part I: The Warlock

Behold the **Warlock**, known as Keeper of the Throne, Blade-Bearer, and The Furious Lord of Lords. He is the oath-sworn Wizard of the Ishanian King, who acts on behalf of the crown of Isha to ensure the stability of power across the archipelago. He is oft of an honorable and harsh temperament, and he is governed by the planet Mars and the metal Iron. It is said the first Warlock was the King's oath-bound court Wizard, and the love shared between the two was only marred by their vicious betrayal.

Within this Part of *The Book of Thrones*, you will be prompted with a number of choices to make on behalf of your Wizard.

Humour & Temperament

Determine your Elements by making choices about your wizard's personality and experiences. Should his answers ever change, adjust his Elements accordingly.

One of the many noble clans of Isha claims you as a member of their family. Were you...

- ☐ Your father's favorite child? (+1 *Earth*)
- ☐ The black sheep of the family? (+1 *Air*)

As a member of the nobility, it is expected for you to possess tremendous wealth. Are you...

- ☐ Frugal and austere? (+1 *Earth*)
- ☐ Spend lavishly on that which appeals to you? (+1 *Water*)

You are a warrior on behalf of the King, and have thus fought in battle. Within your own mind, are you a...

- ☐ Chivalrous hero and adventurer? (+1 *Water*)
- ☐ Brutal executioner? (+1 *Air*)

The King commands you to murder an innocent woman, who begs for your mercy. Do you...

- ☐ Save her life and hide her away? (+1 *Water*)
- ☐ Follow his commands despite your misgivings? (+1 *Fire*)

You serve two masters, and are caught between your loyalties. If forced to choose, would you ultimately follow...

- ☐ The King? (+1 *Air*)
- ☐ The Pact? (+1 *Fire*)

You have killed a man before. When you close your eyes and remember, do you feel...

- ☐ Proud? (+1 *Fire*)
- ☐ Guilty? (+1 *Earth*)

The true form of your fragment of the Seven-Part Pact is a simple blade, but tradition demands that in your hands it takes another form:

- ☐ A regal broadsword, engraved with an oath of power, which may burst into flames at your will. (+1 Fire)
- ☐ A shining longbow, carved with glorious depictions of warriors past, and quickly nocked with gorgeous arrows. (+1 Air)
- ☐ A cruel axe, heavy with blood and executions past, which no man but you may lift. (+1 Earth)
- ☐ Twin cutlasses, one white as bone and the other black as night, well-suited for naval combat. (+1 Water)

You have a familiar who accompanies you in your magic, and who fights by your side when you charge into battle. They are:

- ☐ A glorious stallion, with iron hooves and a flowing mane. (+1 Fire)
- ☐ A powerful hawk, with violent talons and a piercing call. (+1 Air)
- ☐ A growling mastiff, with dull eyes and drooling jaws. (+1 Earth)
- ☐ A playful ermine, with beautiful fur and tiny sharp teeth, (+1 Water)
- ☐ Any other animal, cautious towards others and scarred by war. (+1 to an Element of your choice)

History & Secrets

There was another Wizard before you, your old master who taught you the practice of malison, and in many ways was a father for you. How did he teach you, and what became of him?

Choose 1 which is known to all and 1 which you harbor in secret.

- ☐ He was a popular and gregarious noble, who knew how to inspire largesse in all who knew him, including you. He passed away choking on a bone during a feast, or some similar uneventful and unremarkable death.
- ☐ He was the last of an older kind of hero, a chivalrous knight who raised you on stories of adventure and codes of honor. He was killed by a wild boar during a hunting expedition, a great tragedy that all of Isha mourned.

- ☐ He was a monstrous tyrant, finding pleasure from the misery of others, and who taught you both to inflict violence on others and to suffer it. He died while fighting against one of the great foes of the Pact (or perhaps against the old Necromancer).
- ☐ He was a greedy craven coward, who played Isha's politics to maintain his authority, and who taught you the violence of lies and manipulation. You killed him yourself, and it brought you no small pleasure to do so.
- ☐ He was the hound of his betters, and served both the king and the Pact with obedient fury, teaching you to do the same. He died the way all violent dogs do — someone had to finally put him down.
- ☐ You never met the former Warlock, as you were chosen by the King and the Pact working together to fill a vacant seat. You learned much from the agony of trying to fill his shoes.
- ☐ You learned your magic amid the politics and tutors of the court, and you have the scars to prove it. You needed no master to teach you the art of violence.

The one scarcity all Wizards share is time. Wizards discuss their age in scores, periods of twenty years that shape their long and wizened lives. How old are you, and what is expected of you in your age?

- ☐ You are just a boy, far too young to assume the mantle of Warlock, but the sudden death of your old master and the demands of the King forced you to take on power beyond your years.
- ☐ You are a young fellow, not yet two scores old, and it is expected for you to already be betrothed to another noble's daughter, and for you to have engaged in your first duel.
- ☐ You are of a middling age, between two and three scores old, and you are expected to be married, and to have fathered at least one child.
- ☐ You are of a proper age, between three and four scores old, and you are expected to have led a campaign of war, and to have taken many lives.
- ☐ You are of a great age, between four and five scores old, and you are expected to be the patriarch of your clan, and to be among the oldest and wisest within court.
- ☐ You are at least a century old, older than the king, and it is expected for you to be dead by now, and everyone at court is waiting hungrily for your passing.
- ☐ You are far more than a century old, older than entire dynasties of Isha's rule, and you have become part of the architecture of the court, a single constant amid a sea of chaos.

Magic changes those who work with it. Choose 1 change, and another 1 for every score you've been alive:

- ☐ You can move as fast as falling rain, as fast as a hawk, as fast as a battlecry.
- ☐ You are as tall and broad as three men put together, and have the hunger of an army.
- ☐ An extra pair of arms burst from your shoulders, strong enough to lift mountains.
- ☐ Your face contorts to resemble a war-mask, with fearsome eyes and tusks jutting from your lips.
- ☐ You can smell blood better than a hound, and you can smell in someone's sweat their fear and hate.
- ☐ A flaming ring burns above your head, which shines brighter in your anger and fury.
- ☐ Your blood is blue, and scalding for any who touch it.
- ☐ Armor grows from your skin, scales and plate etched with tales of your exploits.
- ☐ Multiple pairs of iron wings extend from your back, sharp enough to cut skin and strong enough to carry you through the air.
- ☐ When you rage your breath transforms into flames, and you may breathe fire the way a dragon might.
- ☐ A long barbed tail juts from your back, prehensile and dripping poison.
- ☐ Your teeth are sharpened to points and your tongue lolls from your mouth like a dog.
- ☐ You crave the taste of human flesh.

You are a man, as all Wizards are. However within your heart you know:

- ☐ To be a man is to be a leader and dominate over others, and you are always at the beck and call of your master.
- ☐ To be a man is to be a chivalrous hero, and yet this world has no more room for heroes, and chivalry is an easy way to a pathetic death.
- ☐ Some deep-set part of you is repulsed by your maleness, and so you double down into a crueler and harsher version of masculinity.
- ☐ There is some part of you which is kind and caring and distinctly feminine, but you must guard that part of your heart from the violence of your job, and only show it to those closest to you.
- ☐ You were once a woman, but you had no choice but to kill that part of you, and reject the weakness of femininity in order to serve the King.

- ☐ No one dares speculate on your manhood. You would kill the next person to make such a claim in front of you.
- ☐ There is an even greater secret, which is for you and you alone.

Your name as a Wizard within the Seven-Part Pact is:

- ☐ A name taken from military history or from a great king of the past.
- ☐ A title bestowed upon you by the King himself.
- ☐ An honorific earned from your exploits in battle.
- ☐ A nickname picked up in the halls of the court.

Might & Trappings

Through your Pact-Fragment, you may:

- When casting a spell directly against an unwilling foe, or when casting any spell during Combat (as discussed during *Part IV*), consult an additional die.
- During the Initiation of a spell, interpret the presence of "☉" (Salt) as "♂" (Mars).
- Murder any mundane person who stands before you with a single strike of your Pact-Fragment, faster than they can react and with such certainty that none may dispute their death. [footnote: A mundane person is someone without Wards.]

Along with your Pact-Fragment, you possess 3 Treasures. Pick which ones you inherited from your old master, which were gifted to you by the King for your service, and which you won in combat:

- ☐ Armor forged from old mage-steel, scavenged up from beneath the seas, and strong enough to withstand any blow from a mundane weapon.
- ☐ A shield bearing a perfectly mirrored surface, and reflecting certain lesser magics back at those who seek you harm.
- ☐ A pair of greaves bearing feathery wings, such that when you strike them against the ground by your will, they lift you up into the air at a tremendous speed.
- ☐ A full set of chess pieces, who when commanded, will transform into soldiers and fight at your side until sunrise.
- ☐ An iron ring used in ancient days by torturers and soldiers amidst the Tragedies. Whoever wears it cannot die from any wound.

- ☐ One of the last dragon's eggs, rare beyond measure and warm to the touch.
- ☐ A beautiful locket on a delicate chain, the sort carried by soldiers on a long campaign, with enough room for a portrait of someone you long for.

Additionally, you are adept at the secret practices of malison, which grant you access to certain Humble Magics, cantrips which you may perform at any time through your will and without any incantation. They include:

- Perform a daring feat of physical athleticism which dazzles others' senses, leap into the air, or lift heavy stones which no one else could lift.
- Roar with a thunderous voice, or carry your voice across a battlefield, or act with the sounds of drums and horns at your steps, to motivate your troops or dismay others.
- Place both hands upon someone's shoulders, and in an instant divine whether they are an eligible heir for the bloodline of Isha's royalty.

Finally, you carry the following possessions:

- A red silk robe, with iron clasps bearing the symbol of Mars.
- Three sets of clothes, at least: suitable for a wealthy nobleman, a general commanding an army, or a simple servant incognito amongst the court.
- Any materials necessary for the casting of magic, such as: arrowheads, golden coins, flowers, etc.
- Any accessibility aids or mobility tools, such as: glasses, a cane, painkillers, etc.
- This very Codex, filled with the notes of Warlocks past.

Part II: The Keep upon the Halcyon Isles

In the monumental fortress of the past the Warlock schemes, surrounded by those few useful enough to keep his company. It is a cutthroat and bitter life, here at the head of Isha, but it is the seat of power for the Furious Lord of Lords, and all know to watch their backs when they visit his home.

Within this Part of *The Book of Thrones*, you will be prompted with a number of choices to make about your wizard's Isle, Sanctum, and Companions.

Companions

While your wizard is powerful, he is also mortal, and as a mortal, he requires care from others to survive. Each Element is associated with the ways his Companions care for him.

- His **Earth Companion** cares for his daily life, ensuring his quarters are kept clean, his vestments are prepared, and only the finest foods will touch his plate.
- His **Water Companion** cares for his emotional life, comforting him when his thoughts turn violent, keeping his bed warm each night, and washing his scars with herbal baths.
- His **Air Companion** cares for his private life, guarding his Keep from spies and assassins, concealing his emotions from the outside world, and ensuring his secrets never leave this room.
- His **Fire Companion** cares for his creative life, providing conversation late into the night, practice with both strategy and physical skill, and stimulating conversation on the nature of power.

Choose four Companions, with at least 1 Companion who lives within the Keep and at least 1 who prefers the comforts of the King's Palace, determine the answer to their question, and assign each to care for a particular Element:

- ☐ Your prentice, who must serve as Warlock when you die. *Why is your prentice still not enough of a man to be Warlock?*
- ☐ Your wife, an arranged marriage from an allied clan. *What benefits do you both gain from the arranged marriage?*
- ☐ Your son, naive to the violence of power. *Why will your son never be suited to be your prentice?*
- ☐ Your daughter, beautiful and still unmarried. *How have you protected her from the obligations of a noble woman?*
- ☐ Your sibling, who tends to the affairs of your family estates. *How does your sibling enrich themself off of your status and authority?*
- ☐ Your lover, who doesn't care about your scars or your titles. *Why must your relationship stay secret from the court?*

- ☐ Your tutor, who trained you in matters of the court. *What knowledge would your tutor never give you?*
- ☐ Your soldiers, who are willing to die by your command. *What illicit vice do your soldiers indulge in?*
- ☐ Your ancestor, whose spirit watches over your lineage. *Why is your ancestor disappointed in what you've become?*

Should one of your wizard's Companions ever depart, die, or become unwilling to take care of their Element, he must do so himself. Each month he must spend Time providing this missing care, perhaps by drinking heavily, sleeping with the King's courtesans, or even going out into the streets of Isha and murdering whatever poor souls cross his path. Until he does so, the associated Element will be reduced to 0 for the duration of the month.

The Halcyon Isles

Secrets of the Halcyon Isles

The Halcyon Isles are the place you call home, a set of islands that surround the King's Palace. You may spend Time upon your Map to care for your Isle, and in doing so, change or add further to its Lore.

- The Halcyon Isles are a beautiful and serene place, with rolling hills, sprawling gardens, and groves of carefully-tended trees tucked away amid its towering cliffs.
- The Castle of the King looks over the Halcyon Isles, an enormous structure of great hewn stone and bearing countless towers and parapets overlooking the southern seas.
- It is rumored the palace was built by giants, for the doorways are far too large for any man and the stairs had to be carved anew. Generations of kings have further added to the castle, with incongruous and spectacular new wings.
- The largest settlement in the Halcyon Isles is the city of Kingsport, inhabited mostly by servants and merchants who exist solely to cater to the nobility as a rustic vacation town.
- The Halcyon Isles require incredible amounts of produce and manpower from the rest of the archipelago in order to maintain the hedonistic lifestyle of the nobles who dwell there.

The Warlock's Keep is a small castle built across a narrow strait from the palace of the King, and serves as your private Sanctum from the outside world. You may spend Time upon your Map to care for your Sanctum, and in doing so, change or add to its Lore further.

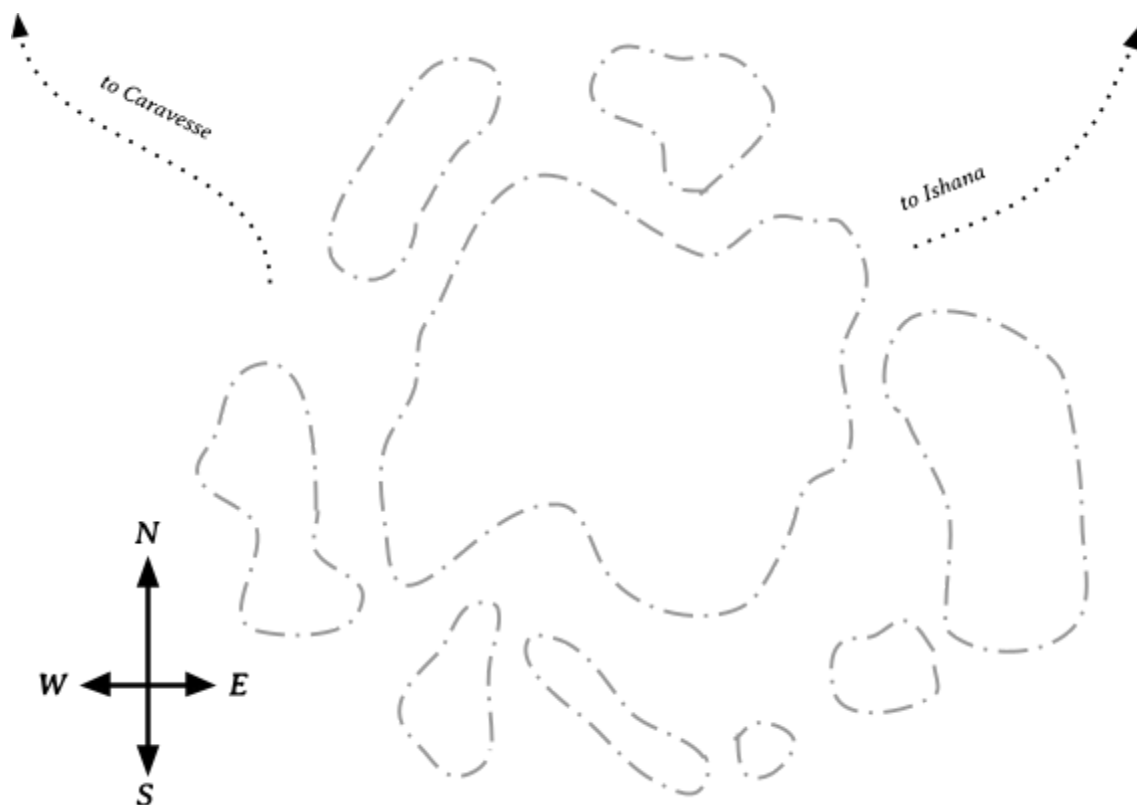
- The keep of the Warlock is musty and minimalist, maintained by servants too afraid to move anything that could be valuable.
- The keep is enormous and uncomfortable, with ceilings too tall for any human and doorways made for giants.
- The keep is covered in tapestries and trophies of wars long forgotten, surrounding you with your own inadequacy.
- A bridge runs from the palace directly to your sleeping chambers, allowing the King to fetch you at his whims.
- Traps prepared by paranoid Warlocks previous to you litter the lower floors and walls, and you must tread carefully, lest you accidentally set one of them off.

Map of the Halcyon Isles

Complete and mark the map of the Graven Isle. It should include some or all of the following details:

- The Warlock's Keep.
- The portion of the Palace the King currently dwells in.
- The abandoned ruins of the Old Palace.
- The chateaus of the five Noble Clans.
- The town of Kingsport and where servants dwell.
- Where the powerful go to relax.
- Where the cunning go to scheme in secret.

[description: A map of the Halcyon Isles, with a compass rose and an arrow pointing Northwest labeled "to Caravesse" and towards the Northeast labeled "to Ishana." The map is dotted .]



Part III: The Court of the King

The King of Isha sits upon a sturdy throne at the heart of his bustling court, full of politicians and generals, heirs and traitors, all squabbling and bickering over their part of the great coffers of power. To rule over Isha is to find agreement between a thousand conflicting interests, to consolidate countless factions into a single mighty force. You ought not to envy the King, although you may be grateful that he has you to aid him in his plans.

Within this Part of *The Book of Thrones*, you will learn more of the Laws of the Court, your time in the service of the King, and the bare-faced mechanisms of power which govern the archipelago. This will cover the rules for managing the politics of the court, working both with and against the whims of the king, and what to look for each month as the stars change within the sky.

Entering The Court

The King of Isha

Within the walls of the palace, the stars and planets orbit only around the King of Isha, the Halcyon King, the Divine Regent of the Immortal Flames, Most Wise, and the Summer Lord of a Thousand Isles. His personality is determined by the placement of his Sun, Moon, and Rising Signs, themselves determined by .[footnote: Each sign contains a positive and a negative view. Both are true at various points, based on people's broader opinions of the king and his own self-esteem.]

Sun Sign — *The King outwardly appears to be...*

Moon Sign — *The King is secretly...*

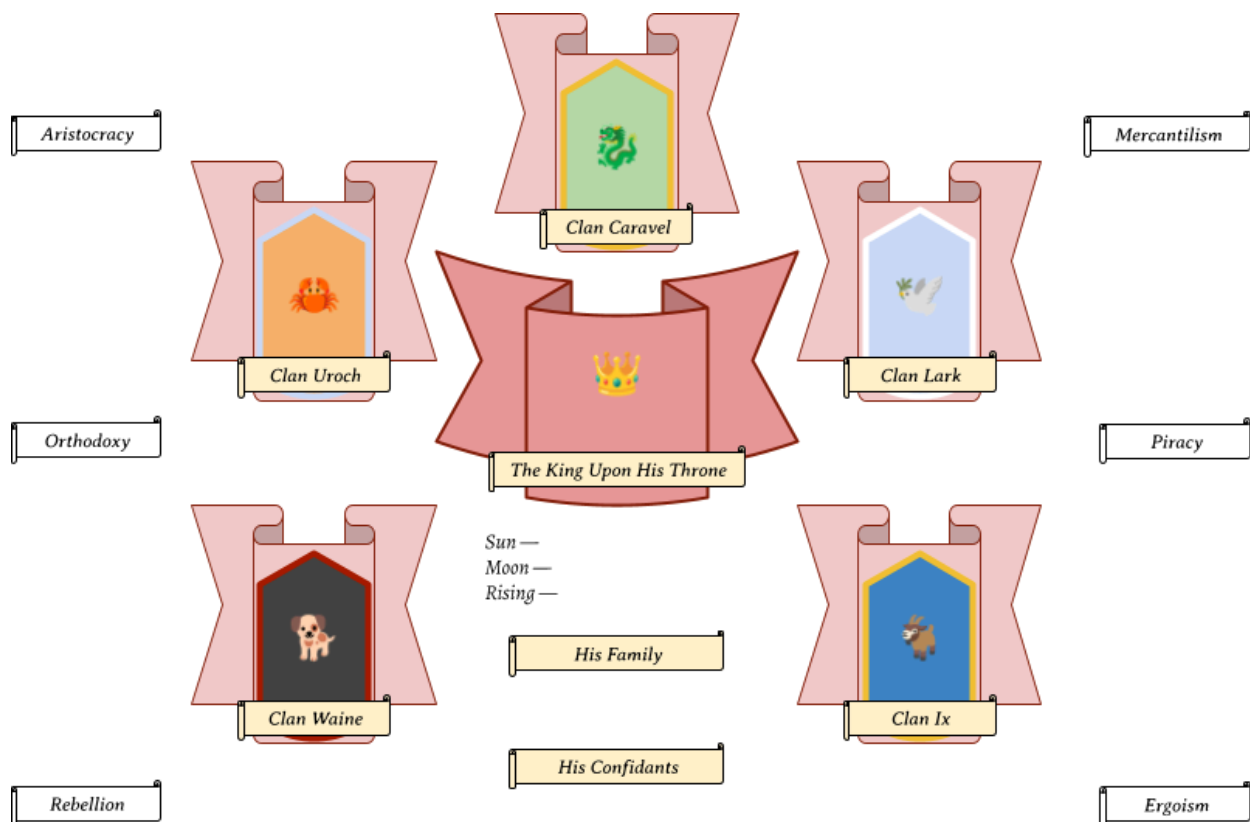
Rising Sign — *The King wishes he was...*

- ☐ Aries — A righteous warrior *or* an argumentative fool.
- ☐ Taurus — A sturdy commander *or* a stubborn bastard.
- ☐ Gemini — A beloved diplomat *or* a two-faced spymaster.
- ☐ Cancer — A romantic lover *or* a weepy crybaby.
- ☐ Leo — A legendary hero *or* an arrogant braggart.
- ☐ Virgo — A nurturing father *or* a scrupulous penny-pincher.
- ☐ Libra — A prudent philosopher *or* a cowardly people-pleaser.
- ☐ Scorpio — A brilliant artist *or* a manipulative rat.
- ☐ Sagittarius — A noble champion *or* a furious tyrant.
- ☐ Capricorn — A dependable guardian *or* a miserable melancholic.
- ☐ Aquarius — A scholarly genius *or* a pseudointellectual windbag.
- ☐ Pisces — An amateur wizard in his own right *or* a delusional madman.

The King's name may be of any style you think is appropriate, and is frequently followed by a number. A King is given a new name upon his ascent to the throne, to align him in history with his predecessors. While Kings lack surnames, they are traditionally and proudly one of the noble **Clans**. For the page Age, they have all been descendents of **Clan Caravel**.

The five noble Clans are:

- **Clan Caravel**, who long ago mastered the holy art of ship-building, and control the sacred shipwright houses, their timber groves, and their secrets. Their Heraldry is a *dragon*.
- **Clan Uroch**, who are responsible for creating many of Isha's great works of art, and control the royal quarries, the order of stonemasons, and the lapidary association. Their Heraldry is a *crab*.
- **Clan Lark**, who profit off of Isha's bountiful oceans, and control the fisheries, dye-markets, and the drowned towers of Old Isha. Their Heraldry is a *songbird*.
- **Clan Waine**, who ferry the dead and dying out to the Graven Isle, and control the black freight, the surgeon guilds, and (in secret) the import of illegal magic and goods from Scuttleport. Their Heraldry is a *dog*.
- **Clan Ix**, who safeguard Isha's secret liturgical writing systems, and control Isha's scriptorium, the vellum drovers, and the lesser universities. Their Heraldry is a *goat*.



The Laws of the Court

Choose 2 which must be followed by all who seek to be respected by the aristocracy of Isha:

- ☐ One must not speak to one's superiors without first being spoken to.
- ☐ One must always speak kindly of other nobles and agree with them, challenging them only through subtle reframing.
- ☐ One must always be dressed in elaborate silks, gowns, armors, and other decorative elements which can take many hours to adorn.
- ☐ One must follow elaborate rules of etiquette while eating and dining, the subtleties of which require extensive training.
- ☐ One must gift lavishly and excessively to all other nobility they encounter.
- ☐ One must not lift an object or perform any common labor without the aid of one's servants.
- ☐ One must never speak the name of the previous King in polite company.

Consequences for failing to follow the Laws of the Throne while in the presence of the King can be found in *Part IV: Watcher of the Throne — Legal Justice* on page XXXX.

Rules of the Court

Lords & Ladies of Isha

The nobility of the five Clans manipulate the world around them through every tool at their disposal. The power of the Clans is limited by the grace of the King, but that grace can be manipulated through earning the affections of his heart.

Each Clan is composed of a set of **Lord Cards**, composed of the following aspects:

- **The Lord's Title**, his formal rank (*such as "Earl of Spyrholm" or "Pontifex of the Immortal Flame"*)
- **His Power**, what the Lord will do if he's given the chance.
- **His Ideology**, the dangerous sedition which ferments if he's Distracted.
- **The Associated Wizard**, the wizard whose Domain is most shaped by his rule.
- **The Lord's Location**, his seat of power.

During the Visions Phase, a set of Lord Cards are pulled from specific Clans determined by the King's **Ladies**. Ladies don't have power the way Lords do, but instead they either occupy the role of **Family** or **Confidant** for the King. For each Lady in the King's Family, pull a Lord card from that Lady's associated Clan. Then pull a Lord card from the associated Clan of the first Lady in the King's Confidants and move that Lady to the bottom of the list. These cards together serve as the King's **Agenda**, the Lords he's empowering that month.

During the Quiet Phase of the month, Lords will perform their Agendas, reshaping Isha to reflect their power. Some Agendas can be used by canny wizards to help their Domains and advance their interests. Some Agendas are irritating or downright antagonistic to the Pact, and must be prevented at all costs. Then, each Clan whose Lord performed his Agenda gains **Favor**. This Favor is used at the end of each season to see how the Clan reshapes royal politics.

One may schedule Time on any Lord in the King's Agenda to mollify him with food, hunting, wine, and the pleasures of the flesh. Spend that Time to turn the Lord clockwise, indicating he's been **Distracted**. Distracted Lords will not perform their Agenda, but will instead move one **Authority** from the King to one of the perfidious **Ideologies** that threaten the Monarchy.

Lords, Ladies, and Gender [box]

It shouldn't be a surprise that the extremely misogynistic and gender-segregated world of the nobility is also mechanically dimorphous. It is culturally assumed that Lords are male and Ladies are female. However there are rare examples to the contrary — a stubborn butch knight may be a female Lord, or a beautiful male bard may romance the King amongst his Confidants. Certainly, Eunuchs are considered Ladies in the eyes of the Court. These are considered scandalous and would be mocked in aristocratic circles, used as examples of the illegitimacy of the King.

Authority & Ideology

Authority tokens represent the centralized power and respect commanded by the King, and the ways that power leaks out into the hands of others. As outside Ideologies obtain more Authority, they make increasingly drastic changes to the political landscape of Isha, culminating in their overthrow (either explicitly or covertly) of the throne and the assertion of a new political model to command the archipelago.

The outside Ideologies are:

- **Aristocracy**, that the lords and ladies of the noble Clans should determine the future of the archipelago.
- **Mercantilism**, that the wealthy merchants and bourgeoisie of Isha should determine the future of the archipelago.
- **Orthodoxy**, that the priests of the Immortal Flame should determine the future of the archipelago.
- **Piracy**, that might makes right and whoever has the most military strength should determine the future of the archipelago.
- **Rebellion**, that the systems of power in Isha are fundamentally broken and must be destroyed at all costs, and the people should determine the future of the archipelago.
- **Ergoism**, that the old wizards of Isha are the true rulers of the world, and they should be trusted to decide the future of the archipelago.

As each Ideology gains Authority it also adds Laws and modifies the rules of the Court of the King. More information on each Ideology can be found starting on page XXXX. [footnote: If this is your first time playing as Warlock, you are encouraged to avoid reading the effects of each Ideology until you encounter them in play. They'll be more interesting and less overwhelming that way.]

One may schedule Time on any Ideology to publicly undermine them and secure the King's power. Spend that Time to move up to two Authority from that Ideology back to the King.

Garrisons

If the King has excess Authority, you can use it to help your fellow wizards by establishing **Garrisons**. Garrisons are castles positioned in other wizards' Domains that serve as a first line of defense against other problems. Each Garrison has Authority on it. If that wizard would suffer a Complication caused by another wizard or a spell, he may remove an Authority from the Garrison and prevent the Complication.

You may schedule Time with your Pact-Fragment on the King to encourage him to support your fellow wizards. Spend that Time to create a Garrison in another wizard's Domain and move an Authority from the King onto that Garrison.

Questing & Dead Lords

Sometimes Lords embark on Quests to other Domains. When a Lord is on a Quest, place them in another Domain.

At the start of the Visions Phase, for each Lord on a Quest, ask the Lord's associated Watcher whether he fulfills his Quest. If he doesn't, give that wizard a minor Gift, move one Authority from the King onto the Lord, and move the Lord to another Domain. If he does, give that Domain a Complication, move all of that Lord's Authority to the Lord's Ideology, place an equal amount of Favor on the Lord's Clan, and place that Lord in the King's Agenda.

A Questing Lord cannot be in the same Domain twice. By the time he reaches his final Domain, he must achieve his Quest.

If a Lord dies, his Title becomes unoccupied. Place it turned 90 degrees near its associated Ideology. Until a Lord is found to occupy that Title, it is considered permanently Distracted, moving Authority to its associated Ideology each month.

Favor & the Royal Ball

At the end of each season (the Quiet Phases of March, June, September, and December), the nobles of Isha gather for a **Royal Ball**, during which they turn their Favors into lavish displays of personal authority and assert themselves onto the fabric of cosmopolitan life.

Remove all Favor from each Clan. Based on the number of Favor removed this way, certain effects occur:

- ***If zero Favor was removed***, the Clan has been ostracized from the social world of Isha. Place an **Errant Lady** from that Clan, along with half of that Clan's Lords (chosen randomly) in any other wizard's Domain.
- ***If 1 Favor was removed***, the Clan makes money working with alternate Ideologies. Move one Authority from the King to any random Ideology.
- ***If 2 Favor was removed***, the Clan seeks to improve its standing in Ishanian society. Place a Lady from the Clan amongst the King's Confidants.
- ***If 3 or 4 Favor was removed***, the Clan is respected and venerated. They take any one unclaimed Title.

- ***If 5 or more Favor was removed***, the Clan is more well-respected than the King. Move 2 Authority from the King to Aristocracy.

Summary of the Court [box]

During the Visions Phase...

1. For each Lord on a Quest, follow the rules on page XXXX for their Quest.
2. For each Lady in the King's Family, pull a Lord card from that Lady's associated Clan. Then pull a Lord card from the associated Clan of the first Lady in the King's Confidants and move that Lady to the bottom of the list. These cards together serve as the current Agenda.
3. Consult the Orrery in reference to *Watching The Stars* (page XXXX) to determine how the Domain changes.

During the Quiet Phase...

1. Resolve each Active Lord's Agenda, making changes to other Domains.
2. Move Authority from the King to other Ideologies based on the Distracted Lords.
3. Move all Lords in the Agenda back to their associated Clan Decks.
4. If it's the Quiet Phase at the end of a season (March, June, September, December), each Clan spends all Favor at the Royal Ball, per page XXXX.

Remember...

- Whenever a character breaks a Law, you may inflict a Complication on any wizard.
- Whenever an Ideology gains Authority, it makes changes to Isha according to its rules (page XXXX).
- If a Lord dies, his Title remains in play permanently Distracted.

You may...

- Schedule Time on a Lord in the King's Agenda to indulge their desires. Spend that Time to Distract the Lord.
- Schedule Time on an Ideology to publicly undermine its perspective. Spend that Time to move up to 2 Authority from that Ideology to the King.
- Schedule Time with your Pact-Fragment on the King to encourage him to wield his power. Spend that Time to create a Garrison in any other Domain and move an Authority onto it.
- Schedule Time with your Pact-Fragment on any non-magical Denizen to kill them instantly. (*This may be against the Law.*)

Watching The Stars

To ascertain the whims of the King and how he acts upon the world, look to what lies in conjunction with the King's Sun, Moon, and Rising Signs each month upon the Orrery. Consult each Celestial Body in its order.

If **Mercury** (♿) is in conjunction with **any** of the signs, the King struggles to maintain power. Move one Authority from the King to any Ideology with the lowest Authority.

If **Venus** (♀) is in conjunction with **any** of the signs, power leeches from the King's grasp. Move one Authority from the King to any Ideology with the highest Authority.

If **Mars** (♂) is in conjunction with **any** of the signs, the King turns to outside advice to guide his hand. Draw a random Lord from any Clan who didn't otherwise contribute to the Agenda this month.

If **Jupiter** (♃) is in conjunction with the King's **Sun Sign**, one of the King's lovers gives birth to a son. Choose a Lady. During the Royal Ball this season, if that Lady is still alive, place a *Bastard Son of the King* Title in that Confidant's associated Clan. *(If this conjunction has occurred multiple times this season, its associated event only happens once.)*

If **Jupiter** (♃) is in conjunction with the King's **Moon Sign**, one of the King's lovers gives birth to a daughter. Choose a Lady. During the Royal Ball this season, if that Lady is still alive, add a Lady from that Clan to the King's Family. *(If this conjunction has occurred multiple times this season, its associated event only happens once.)*

If **Jupiter** (♃) is in conjunction with the King's **Rising Sign**, the King offers the hand of one of his daughters in marriage to another. During the Royal Ball this season, remove a Lady from the King's Family and move a Lord from the non-royal Clan with the most Favor to the King's Clan.

If **Saturn** (♄) is in conjunction with the King's **Sun Sign**, the loves of the King grow weak. Roll two d10s — one for the King's Family and one for his Confidants. For each "1" (Saturn) rolled, a Lady of your choice from that group dies.

If **Saturn** (♄) is in conjunction with the King's **Moon Sign**, the Lords of Isha take stock of their health. For each Clan, roll a d10. For each "1" (Saturn) rolled, kill a random Lord from that Clan.

If **Saturn** (♄) is in conjunction with the King's **Rising Sign**, the King of Isha's health is threatened. Roll a d12. If "♄" (Saturn) is rolled, the King grows deathly ill. Unless someone can aid him, through magic or medical care, he will die at the end of the month.

If **The Sun** (☉) is in conjunction with the King's **Sun Sign**, it's the King's birthday. Each wizard may schedule Time on the King this month to attend a collective scene celebrating the King's birthday, during which they must follow the Laws of the Court and present the King with a present that pleases him. Give each wizard who fails to do this a Complication.

If **The Sun** (☉) is in conjunction with the King's **Moon Sign**, the King passes a new Law reflecting the positive qualities of how he wants people to perceive him. Choose any Law and inform the Celestial Audience and ask them if they plan to follow it. If they do, move an Authority from any Ideology to the King. If they don't, move two Authority from the King to any two Ideologies that most fervently oppose the Law.

If **The Sun** (☉) is in conjunction with the King's **Rising Sign**, the King passes a new Law reflecting the negative qualities of how people perceive him. Choose any Law and inform the Celestial Audience and ask them if they plan to follow it. If they do, move an Authority from any Ideology to the King. If they don't, move two Authority from the King to any two Ideologies that most fervently oppose the Law.

Ideologies

Aristocracy

Aristocracy claims that the lords and ladies of the noble Clans should determine the future of the archipelago.

If Aristocracy has at least 1 Authority, there is a Law: Only Clan members may wear the colors of their Clan.

If Aristocracy has at least 2 Authority, Lords and Ladies may choose to violate Laws, as long as they're subtle and reserved about it.

When Aristocracy gains its 3rd Authority, choose a Lord with the Aristocracy Ideology from any Clan. They embark on a Quest in another wizard's Domain.

If Aristocracy has at least 5 Authority, Noble Clans can possess their own Authority independent from the King. Clan Authority counts towards Aristocracy's Authority for the purposes of determining who Truly Wiolds Power, and Clan Authority counts as Favor for the Royal Ball. Whenever a Lord enacts his Agenda, move 1 Authority from the King to that Lord's Clan.

If Aristocracy has at least 6 Authority, add a new rule to Watching the Stars:

If **Mars** (♂) is in conjunction with **any** of the King's signs, the Clans with the most and least Favor Duel. Flip over the top Lord of each Clan and determine who, in your opinion, would win. The winner takes all Favor and Authority from the losing Clan. The loser dies.

If Aristocracy has at least 8 Authority, the aristocrats now dictate the Agenda of the King. Instead of how the King normally determines Lords, place Lords from Clans with Authority (starting with the Clan with the most Authority) until all Clans have placed a Lord. Repeat this if fewer than three Lords were placed.

If Aristocracy Truly Wiolds Power, the King is no longer the seat of power in Isha, and has been replaced by the Parliament composed of landholding nobility. When this occurs, create a Complication for each other wizard, and make a Gamechanging Impact on your own Domain to reflect the new Parliamentary system. Move all Authority from the Aristocracy onto this new representation of Parliament.

Mercantilism

Mercantilism claims that the wealthy merchants and bourgeoisie of Isha should determine the future of the archipelago.

If Mercantilism has at least 1 Authority, there is a Law: It is illegal to cause property damage to a business.

If Mercantilism has at least 2 Authority, merchants and companies may choose to violate Laws, as long as they're subtle and reserved about it.

When Mercantilism gains its 3rd Authority, a wizard is approached by a prominent merchant guild, bank, or corporate operation to make a deal. If the wizard spends Time next month having a scene with that merchant, they can choose to partner with that merchant. Change the Lore of the wizard's Isle or Sanctum appropriately. At the end of each month, if the wizard took

action to further the interests of that merchant, give the wizard a minor Gift and Mercantilism gains another Authority from the King.

If Mercantilism has at least 5 Authority, Markets can now possess Authority. Whenever a Market is established in the Mariner's Domain, move an Authority from the King onto that Market. This Authority counts towards Mercantilism's Authority for the purposes of determining who Truly Wields Power. Whenever a Lord acts from that Market's Isle, move 1 Authority from the King to the Market and place 1 Heraldry from that Lord's Clan on the Market. If the Market would be destroyed, it instead either removes 1 Heraldry or returns 1 Authority to the King. As long as any Market has Authority, this Ideology cannot lose Authority.

If Mercantilism has at least 6 Authority, add a new rule to Watching the Stars:

If **Mars** (♂) is in conjunction with **any** of the King's signs, new Markets open across Isha. Take a Market from the Mariner's Domain and a Garrison and place it in any wizard's Domain. At the start of each month, give the associated wizard a minor Gift and move 1 Authority from the King to this Market.

Whenever a Lord's Agenda Impacts a Market's Domain, move 1 Authority from the King to the Market and place 1 Heraldry from that Lord's Clan on the Market.

If Mercantilism has at least 8 Authority, the King's Agenda is dictated by who can afford it. Ignore his Family and Confidants. Instead, for each Heraldry on the Market with the most Authority, pull a Lord and place it in the Agenda. If fewer than three Lords are pulled this way, the King determines the remainder according to his Family and Confidants.

If Mercantilism Truly Wields Power, the King is no longer the seat of power in Isha, and has been supplanted by the flow of wealth and money in the markets. When this occurs, create a Complication for each other wizard, and make a Gamechanging Impact on your own Domain to reflect the advent of capitalism. Move all Authority from Mercantilism onto this new representation of the market.

Orthodoxy

Orthodoxy claims that the priests of the Immortal Flame should determine the future of the archipelago.

If Orthodoxy has at least 1 Authority, there is a Law: It is illegal to reject the divinity of the Immortal Flames.

If Orthodoxy has at least 2 Authority, the clergy of the Temples may choose to violate Laws, as long as they're subtle and reserved about it.

When Orthodoxy gains its 3rd Authority, the King publicly announces his commitment to the Immortal Flame. Each of the Hierophant's Temples gains +2 Abundance. Next month, any wizards may spend Time attending the religious holiday in a collective scene and demonstrating their faith. Each wizard who does so gains a Gift.

If Orthodoxy has at least 5 Authority, Temples can now possess Authority. Whenever a Temple celebrates a Holiday or a Lord's Agenda Impacts the Hierophant's Domain, move 1 Authority from the King onto that Temple. This Authority counts towards Orthodoxy's Authority for the purposes of determining who Truly Wields Power. The Hierophant may spend Time on a Temple and gain either +1 Abundance or Conviction on that Temple for each Authority it has. Whenever a Temple changes Doctrine, move all Authority from the Temple back to the King.

When Orthodoxy gains its 6th Authority, the Orthodoxy becomes a new Clan, composed of the four Abbot cards and the Pontifex card (moved from their other Clans to the Orthodoxy). Place a Lady from this Clan in the King's Confidants and remove all other Confidants. Add a new rule to Watching the Stars:

If **Mars** (♂) is in conjunction with **any** of the King's signs, the Clans must prove their devotion to Isha. Each other Clan must spend 1 Conviction or demonstrate penance, moving a Lord from their Clan into the Orthodoxy and gaining 2 Conviction.

If Orthodoxy has at least 8 Authority, the faith now dictates the Agenda of the King. Ignore the King's Family and Confidants. Instead, pull three Lords from the Orthodoxy each month.

If Orthodoxy Truly Wields Power, the King is no longer the seat of power in Isha, and has been replaced by the authority of the faith itself. When this occurs, create a Complication for each other wizard, and make a Gamechanging Impact on your own Domain to establish a new Ecclesiocracy. Move all Authority from the Orthodoxy onto this new church-state.

Piracy

Piracy claims that might makes right, and whoever has the most military strength should determine the future of the archipelago.

If Piracy has at least 1 Authority, anyone may choose to violate Laws, as long as they're subtle and reserved about it.

If Piracy has at least 2 Authority, anyone may openly and brazenly violate Laws, as long as they bribe any guards who happen to catch them.

When Piracy gains its 3rd Authority, a wizard is approached by one of the four Criminal Syndicates [footnote: See *The Book of Chains, Part VI — Criminal Syndicates* on page XXXX.] to make a deal. If the wizard spends Time next month having a scene with that criminal, they can choose to partner with that Syndicate. Change the Lore of the wizard's Isle or Sanctum appropriately. At the end of each month, if the wizard took action to further the interests of the Syndicate, give the wizard a minor Gift and Piracy gains another Authority from the King.

If Piracy has at least 5 Authority, the Pirates become a new Clan, composed of all Unclaimed Titles. Whenever a Lord dies, his Title is moved to the Pirate Clan, as the syndicates fill in the missing services. Each month, *always* add a Lord from the Pirates to the Agenda. The Faustian may draw from the Pirate Clan Deck when creating Accomplices (each Lord counts as a 8). If the Lord ever Falls while acting as an Accomplice, or Dies while acting amongst the Pirate Clans, the Devil takes the Lord and may choose to perform his Agenda whenever it pleases him.

If Piracy has at least 6 Authority, add a new rule to Watching the Stars:

If **Mars** (♂) is in conjunction with **any** of the King's signs, flip over a Lord from each Clan. These Lords are involved in criminal conspiracies. If that Lord's associated Ideology has at least 1 Authority, the Lord profits from his criminal endeavors and that Clan gains 1 Favor. If that Lord's associated Ideology has 0 Authority, the Lord dies.

If Piracy has at least 8 Authority, the King's centralized authority is no longer recognized. At the start of each month, pull one Lord from each Clan to form the Agenda.

If Piracy Truly Wields Power, Isha's centralized government collapses into a series of petty warlords and regional authorities. Isha descends into Civil War, per page XXXX. Each Authority on Piracy becomes a different regional Pirate-Lord.

Rebellion

Rebellion claims that the systems of power in Isha are fundamentally broken and must be destroyed at all costs, and the people should determine the future of the archipelago.

If Rebellion has at least 1 Authority, the general public will follow the Laws of the Land over the Laws of the King. [footnote: *The Book of Flames*, Part IV: The Laws of the Land, page XXXX.]

If Rebellion has at least 2 Authority, the general public thinks poorly of the King, the Pact, and anyone else with Authority.

When Rebellion gains its 3rd Authority, rebels take shelter in the Isle of any other wizard. That wizard may spend Time next month expelling the rebels and reporting them to the King. If he does, move 1 Authority from the Rebellion to the King. Otherwise, create a Garrison in that Domain, and give the associated wizard a Complication.

If Rebellion has at least 5 Authority, a rebellion establishes itself against the King in another Domain. Take three unused Omens from the Sage, along with a random Lord from any Clan, and place them in another Domain as the Rebellion. Each month, if the King's Agenda Impacts that Domain, remove an Omen from the Rebellion. Otherwise, take a random Lord from any Clan, add them to the Rebellion, and place another Omen on the Rebellion. If that Lord dies, the Rebellion loses an Omen. These Omens count as Authority for the purpose of determining if the Rebellion Truly Wields Power. The Rebellion cannot lose Authority until it loses all Omens.

If Rebellion has at least 6 Authority, add a new rule to Watching the Stars:

If **Mars** (♂) is in conjunction with **any** of the King's signs, the Rebellion sets its own Agenda. Flip over all Lords in the Rebellion and enact their Agendas *immediately*. Then move 1 Authority from the King to the Rebellion.

If Rebellion has at least 8 Authority, the Rebellion enters open conflict against the King of Isha, and Isha descends into a state of Civil War. [footnote: *Civil War*, page XXXX.]

If Rebellion Truly Wields Power, the Rebellion decisively triumphs against the King of Isha and establishes a new government. When this occurs, create a Complication for each other wizard, and make a Gamechanging Impact on your own Domain as the rebellion establishes something new. Move all Authority from the Rebellion onto this new revolutionary system.

Ergoism

Ergoism claims the old wizards of Isha are the true rulers of the world, and they should be trusted to decide the future of the archipelago.

If Ergoism has at least 1 Authority, it is considered fashionable to study and engage with magic, and powerful people will be friendly and accommodating towards wizards.

If Ergoism has at least 2 Authority, the wizards of the Pact may choose to violate Laws, as long as they're subtle and reserved about it.

When Ergoism gains its 3rd Authority, the King invites the Pact to dinner. Any wizard may spend Time next month to have a collective scene with the King, during which he asks the Pact to teach him magic. Each wizard who refuses gets a Complication. Each wizard who agrees gets a minor Gift. If only one wizard agrees, he gets a major Gift. The King becomes a Disruptive Arcanist as long as at least one wizard agrees to teach him.

If Ergoism has at least 5 Authority, the King begins his own magical university. It functions similarly to the Sorcerer's Domain. The University gains an amount of Knowledge each month equal to the total Authority on Ergoism and himself combined. Whenever a Lord is distracted, the King gains either a Professor, a Librarian, or an Alchemist (*your choice*). Ergoism cannot lose Authority as long as any Arcanists (*including the King*) remain in the Court.

When Ergoism gains its 6th Authority, add a new rule to Watching the Stars:

If **Mars** (♂) is in conjunction with **any** of the King's signs, the King works in concert with his servants to cast a spell of Mighty Import at any point during the month. He rolls a number of dice equal to the total Authority on Ergoism.

If Ergoism has at least 8 Authority, the Pact now dictates the Agenda of the King. Ignore the King's Lovers and Confidants. Instead, during the Visions Phase of each month, each wizard chooses a Lord whose Agenda will occur.

If Ergoism Truly Wields Power, a wizard sits upon the throne of Isha. Create a Complication for any other wizard for each Authority on Ergoism, then move all Authority onto the Orrery. If the King was an Arcanist, he has become a wizard in his own right, following the rules in *The Book of Truth, Part V: Other Wizards*, page XXXX. If the King was not an Arcanist, perhaps you sit upon the throne instead. Establish the Wizard-King, per page XXXX.

Monarchy

Monarchy claims that the King should determine the future of the archipelago. It begins as the default Ideology of Isha, without needing commentary, and only becomes a relevant Ideology if the King no longer Truly Wiolds Power in Isha.

If Monarchy has at least 1 Authority, the people of Isha know who the King is and respect him. (If there is no King presently, rumors of a new King begin to spread through Isha.)

If Monarchy has at least 2 Authority, the King's commands are considered Law by the people of Isha.

When Monarchy gains its 3rd Authority, a wizard is approached by the King of Isha to request aid reclaiming his throne. If the wizard spends Time next month having a scene with the King, they can choose to partner with that King. Change the Lore of the wizard's Isle or Sanctum appropriately. At the end of each month, if the wizard took action to further the interests of the King, give the wizard a minor Gift and Monarchy gains another Authority from whoever currently rules it.

If Monarchy has at least 5 Authority, the King regains the loyalty of his armies. Establish an Army in another wizard's Domain. The Army's Authority is equal to the King's own Authority. The King cannot lose Authority until the Army is destroyed.

When Monarchy gains its 6th Authority, add a new rule to Watching the Stars:

If **Mars** (♂) is in conjunction with **any** of the King's signs, the true King decisively strikes against those who oppose his rule. The King Garrisons any other Domain. Each Garrison counts towards the Monarchy's Authority for the purposes of determining who Truly Wiolds Power

If Monarchy has at least 8 Authority, the King now dictates the Agenda of his Domain. Determine the King's Family and Confidants (if any) and follow the original rules for determining Agenda each month to set the King's Agenda.

If Monarchy Truly Wiolds Power, the true King of Isha has been restored to his throne. Give a major Complication to each other wizard. Make a Gamechanging Impact on your own Domain to reflect how the Monarchy is restored.

Arranging the Court

No Matter What

1. Mark the King with the Heraldry of Clan Caravel. Determine the King's Sun, Moon, and Rising signs according to the Age.
2. Place all 24 Authority on the King.
3. Place a Lady from Clan Caravel in the King's Family (the Princess).
4. Place the following cards in their associated Clans:
 - a. **Clan Caravel:** Royal Historian, Pontifex of the Immortal Flame, Warden of Mt. Ithax, Admiral of the Sidereal Sea, Castellan of Caravesse, Magister of the West, Count of the Moonlit Atoll, Knight of the Raven
 - b. **Clan Lark:** Abbot of Temple Ushin, Admiral of the Thyrian Sea, Duke of the Reach, Knight of the Seas, Castellan of Thyrhold, Knight of the Lion, Magister of the East, Ambassador of the Faraway Sea
 - c. **Clan Uroch:** Royal Executioner, Abbot of Temple Krolis, Viceroy of Ishana, Admiral of the Bay of Ishana, Castellan of the Palace, Magister of the South, Steward of the King's Estate
 - d. **Clan Waine:** Baron of the Graven Isle, Knight of the Mist, Abbot of Temple Notor, Admiral of the East, Lord Exchequer of the Treasury, Governor of Scuttleport, Magister of the North, The Roustabout Knight
 - e. **Clan Ix:** Abbot of Temple Zephon, Chancellor of Trade, Castellan of Yeraine, Commander of the City Guard, Knight of the Moon, Lord Pursuivant, Earl of Spyrholm, President of Spyrholm University
5. Set the *Bastard Son of the King* and *Crown Prince of the Halcyon Isles* titles aside.

Quiet Arrangement

Then, to prepare the Court of the King for a Quiet Arrangement, perform the following actions:

1. Place a Lady from any Clan besides Caravel in the King's Family (*this is the Queen*). Place the *Crown Prince of the Halcyon Isles* Title in her Clan.
2. Place two Ladies from any two Clans presently without Ladies in the King's Confidants.

3. Place one Favor in each Clan with a Lady.
4. Move one Authority from the King to Aristocracy.

Dynamic Arrangement

Then, to prepare the Court of the King for a Dynamic Arrangement, perform the following actions:

1. Place a Lady from any Clan besides Caravel in the King's Family (*this is the Queen*). Place the *Crown Prince of the Halcyon Isles* Title in her Clan.
2. Place two Ladies from any two Clans presently without Ladies in the King's Confidants. In one of them, place a *Bastard Son of the King* Title in their Clans.
3. Place one Favor in each Clan with a Lady.
4. Flip over the top Lord of each Clan. Move an Authority from the King to that Lord's Ideology.

Explosive Arrangement

Then, to prepare the Court of the King for an Explosive Arrangement, perform the following actions:

1. Place a Lady from any Clan besides Caravel in the King's Family (*this is the Queen*). Place the *Crown Prince of the Halcyon Isles* Title in her Clan.
2. Place two Ladies from any two Clans presently without Ladies in the King's Confidants. In each of them, place a *Bastard Son of the King* Title in their Clans.
3. Place two Favor in each Clan with a Lady.
4. Flip over the top Lord of each Clan. Move one Authority from the King to that Lord's Ideology. Then kill each Lord flipped over this way.

Part IV: Watcher to the Throne

While you play the Warlock, there is also a second role which you must fulfill, in your part as **Throne-Watcher** of the **Celestial Audience**. Through the Celestial Audience, you will represent the ceaseless violence of the world, the brutality in the hearts of men and the great machines of war, and ensure that when blood is spilled, Wizards prove themselves men.

Within this Part of *The Book of Thrones*, you will learn your responsibilities as a member of the Celestial Audience and the unique rules governing your own domain, that of warfare and politics, and the violence which underpins them.

Principles of the Throne-Watcher

All wizards are men, indeed: all wizards know this. In your part as the Celestial Audience, you are the guardian of this truth, who provides its implications as they play out across the world of Isha. This truth informs your **Principles**, which guide your hand and inform your decisions. As Throne-Watcher, your Principles are:

Maleness and power are intertwined. To successfully be a powerful man is to be a member of an exclusive club, where women are eager to please and other men vie for your attention. Everyone benefits from this hierarchy, as long as they're willing to play by the rules.

Manhood is enforced through internal and external pressure. There are a tremendous number of expectations tied to masculinity; expectations of abledness, virility, heterosexuality, confidence, and domination. Proving that you're good at being a man means other men will respect you and the women in your life will trust that they can depend on you to protect them. No one will doubt your right to rule if only you're man enough.

Masculinity is performed and asserted through violence. If people start doubting your masculine authority, your grip on power is threatened. The only way to prove (to yourself, to others, to the world) that you're a real man is through dominating those weaker than you. The greater the threat of emasculation and powerlessness, the more pressure you face to commit acts of violence that prove your authority. [footnote: Even if a woman joined the Pact, she would still need to prove herself within this system through cruelty and domination, and the cycle of power would continue unabated.]

Interventions of the Throne-Watcher

When acting as a member of the Celestial Audience, you will have opportunities to advance your Principles and assert your perspective on the world. You may accomplish this through **Interventions**, questions, statements, and Impact which can intrude into any scene at any moment. These include:

- Threaten someone's masculinity.
- Present someone with signs of violence, the consequences of past choices, or the consequences of choosing against violence.
- Describe those who benefit from power and those who are subjugated by it.
- Tell someone how they must behave to prove their masculinity, and ask if they dare.
- Determine that a character is moving towards violence. *Proceed with the Rules for Combat on page XXXX.*

Rules For Combat

Once more, the blade is drawn. Once more, blood must flow. No matter what, we find ourselves here again.

Combat can take many forms, from simple duels to messy brawls to large scale battles. Combats are composed of *Combatants*, individuals or groups who act together. Each Combatant is armed with *Assets*, a short list of weapons, armaments, defenses, incantations, and skills that are relevant for the Combat at hand.

Combat proceeds back and forth, exchanging **The Initiative**: the measure of who is leading the fight, and who is following behind. Skilled Combatants are those who can make elegant and creative use of their Assets, and who can stay on their toes and keep their focus. A fight is a lot like a dance, and the first to stumble will most likely fall.

The Unarmed [box]

The rules for Combat are only relevant if both combatants have access to weaponry. If one Combatant has access to weaponry and the other is unarmed (even if the unarmed Combatant is a wizard), the armed Combatant will immediately win the Combat. If both Combatants are unarmed, it is expected that men will triumph over women, adults will triumph over children, and younger adults will triumph over older adults.

Observing Combat

The Throne-Watcher, and any other members of the Celestial Audience not present in the Combat, have the vital responsibility of observing the fight and adjudicating on what is or isn't

permissible. Throughout every fight, Combatants will be taking various actions, strikes, parries, and responses, and if at any moment any member of the Celestial Audience finds one's behavior to be implausible, they must speak up and challenge this act. Everyone must remember their duties to the believability of the world of Isha and the story of the Pact. While Combat favors those with quick wits, it should be won by those who can ground their actions in believability and previously-established truth.

While a map isn't necessary, it can be helpful for the Celestial Audience to follow along with the events of the fight, especially if they're not participating. Draw a representation of the battlefield, and represent each Combatant with a token placed somewhere on the map. Adjust the tokens as the fight continues on, and use their placement to make decisions about the plausibility of various strikes and parries. For large-scale battles, where a Combatant may have Assets composed of platoons of troops and armadas of ships, instead represent each Asset as its own token on the map.

Other Forms of Combat [box]

There are forms of Combat which lie beyond these rules. Certain dinner parties between powerful nobles, contests of mental will in the realm of Dreams, and academic debates within the University may all be, on occasion, more accurately described as a form of Combat should the Celestial Audience deem it so. In these cases, determine Assets as you feel is appropriate, reflecting the unique circumstances of the fight.

Preparing Assets

At the start of every Combat, for each Combatant, the player representing that Combatant prepares a list of Assets available by answering the following questions about how prepared their Combatant is and what tools they possess. [footnote: Remain honest to the world of Isha — if you were woken up in the middle of the night, you probably don't have any armor!]

- ***What weapons do you possess?*** (Each weapon is a separate Asset)
- ***Are you wearing any armor or wielding a shield?*** (Armor is collectively a single Asset)
- ***Do you have any Treasures on your person?*** (Each Treasure is a separate Asset)
- ***Do you have any magical abilities or know any humble magic?*** (Each magic is a separate Asset)
- ***Are you accompanied by any beasts or lesser servants?*** (Each is considered their own Asset)

- ***Do you have any training or relevant skills?*** (If so, your training is an Asset)
- ***Can you wield the landscape here to your advantage?*** (If so, that familiarity is an Asset)

For wizards, their Assets can be simply the list of Changes of Magic and Treasures in their possession. If the Combat is in their Sanctum, their Sanctum is itself an Asset.

Dueling

A duel between two honorable warriors is the model of violence, from which all other forms are descended. It is a shame, then, how rare they are. When a Duel is to begin, both sides prepare their list of Assets, and the initiator of the Duel seizes the Initiative. The wielder of the Initiative then takes an action, which is responded to by the opposing Combatant. Both duelists go back and forth in this manner, until one is unable to respond.

If you possess the Initiative, you may choose from the following actions...

Say: *"I strike at you with [an Asset], which will [inflict Violence]."* You must justify how this Asset commits violence. The opposing Combatant must now respond.

Say: *"In a decisive blow, I use [an Asset] to destroy [an opposing Asset]."* You must justify how that Asset may be used to so thoroughly destroy the opposing Asset. They lose this Asset, but that opposing Combatant gains the Initiative.

Say: *"I step back and gather my strength."* You pass the Initiative, but create a new Asset, repair a lost Asset, cast a spell, or Flee. If you've taken this action three times in a row, you *must* Flee.

Say: *"I don't know."* You must pass the Initiative.

If you don't possess the Initiative, you may choose from the following responses...

Respond with: *"I parry your strike with [an Asset]."* You must justify how this Asset allows you to avoid or ignore the blow. Your opponent retains the Initiative.

Respond with: *"I take this blow, accepting your violence, but I strike back."* You suffer the injury and pain inflicted by their strike, as many Assets as they can justify you lose, but you seize the Initiative. If the violence is enough to Incapacitate you, you must become Incapacitated.

Respond with: "*I don't know.*" and suffer the pain and injury of the strike, destroying as many Assets as they please and most likely Incapacitating you. In a fight with multiple Combatants, they then pass the Initiative.

Casting Magic

Wizards frequently resort to magic during Combat. Magic isn't quick, however — when one casts a spell, they must step back and pass the Initiative. Record the results of the spell, and treat them as Assets to be utilized. A single spell can create multiple Assets in this fashion. When you use a Spell in this way, some of its properties may be hindered by the opposing Combatant's Wards, if they have any. Once you regain the Initiative, you may use the spell, and if they have no method to defend against such magical attacks, then they'll have no appropriate response.

If a maledictive spell is described as occurring especially quickly, or faster than someone may respond, you immediately regain the Initiative after casting it, as the opposing Combatants simply cannot respond in time.

Fleeing a Fight

When someone has the Initiative, they may attempt to Flee a Combat. When they do so, they describe by what method you Flee (through magic, through a Treasure, through their own two legs, etc.) and whether they have any Assets which make their escape easier. The opposing Combatant may in turn justify which of their Assets could be used to impede the escape. The Celestial Audience decides whether the escape was a success. If it was, the fleeing Combatant is no longer present. If it wasn't, instead the fleeing Combatant loses one of their relevant Assets and the opposing Combatant seizes the Initiative.

Incapacitation and Loss

An Incapacitated Combatant is entirely at the mercy of the winning Combatant. They may choose to take the loser prisoner, maim the loser in some fashion, humiliate them, kill them, or let them go. If they would die, this encounter is no longer your responsibility — ask the Gate-Keeper what happens next.

Multiple Combatants

Fights with multiple Combatants function similarly to Duels, but with certain elements worth addressing.

When one passes the Initiative (by stepping back or hesitating), they must pass it to whoever has been waiting the longest for their turn to act. When an Asset is destroyed with a decisive blow, the Initiative passes to the Combatant whose Asset was destroyed. Combatants who both lack the Initiative and lack any chance to respond can be assumed to be circling around the edge of the fight, licking their wounds and angling for a good attack. The Combat isn't over until all standing Combatants agree it has concluded, at which point they collectively decide what to do with the Incapacitated Combatants.

If a wizard is fighting against a squad of soldiers or another group of less-powerful Combatants, it can make sense to group those warriors together into one Combatant. If you do, choose one from below to best describe them:

- They are a small and skilled team. (*Add an Asset for each team member and their skill*)
- They are a gang of less than 20. (*Add the Asset: "We're able to work together and coordinate."*)
- They are an enormous mob. (*Add the Assets: "Although we are many, we act as one." and "There are a limitless number of us."*)

The Laws of the King

The laws of Isha (much like the laws of any nation) are fickle, arbitrary things, selectively enforced against different people based on the power and approval of the ruling powers. While a peasant can expect to be punished for the violation of any of these laws, a powerful noble can act without fear of consequence, as long as he stays on the good side of the King.

Who Follows The Law

Peasants, merchants, and artisans would be held to the full letter of the law, and if convicted would face heavy fines, dismemberment, or death. Soldiers will face much lighter sentences in civilian trials.

Servants of the Immortal Flame (such as monks or priests) are technically held to the same laws, but in practice the Temples have historically protected criminals within their ranks and ensured they get lighter sentences.

Nobles can expect the legal system to be much lighter on them than it is on others. If the Noble is of the King's Clan, they are effectively above the law entirely, while their Clan is at the edge of authority, they're most likely just as vulnerable as a peasant.

Crimes committed against anyone designated an Outlaw won't be prosecuted.

Where wizards fall in this system depends tremendously on the authority and respect of the Pact in any particular Age, and the willingness of the King and his guards to arrest and try a wizard. Wizards avoid the civilian legal system if at all possible, and will often close ranks to protect one of their own from arrest, preferring to try them within the Pact.

Who Upholds The Law

In the Blue City, and within the Palace, the law is enforced by the King's Guard.

Across the Halcyon Isles, in many smaller Isles, and in rural Isha, the law is enforced by the ruling Clan's Guard. These guards often are more concerned with trespassing and crimes against the ruling Clan, and will sometimes act against the King's interest in favor of their Clan. Sacred Tahv is protected by the militarized servants of the Flame.

Certain isles (such as the Graven Isle, the Starlit Atoll, or the Orrery) have no one present to enforce the law, although crimes committed upon them would theoretically be under the King's purview, and would be tried in Ishana if arrested.

Crimes in Isha

While what is or isn't legal can vary tremendously based on the stances of the King. The following are all actions which are frequently extremely illegal, and are also likely for Wizards to (accidentally or intentionally) violate through the use of magic:

- Adultery, polyamory, or annulment of marriage.
- Arson or the destruction of another's property.

- Cross-dressing, impersonation, or forgery. [footnote: Forging the King's Stamp upon a coin is considered a crime on par with murder, and thus Wizards must be cautious when duplicating coins.]
- Libel, perjury, or blasphemy.
- Murder, battery, or manslaughter.
- Poaching from the King's waters or the King's woods, or the chateau of any Clan.
- Robbery, theft, and vagrancy.
- Sodomy.
- Tax evasion, smuggling, avoiding tariffs.
- Treason, fermenting rebellion, spying for a foreign authority.
- Witchcraft.

Update this list further as the King outlaws or permits various actions.

Legal Justice

When the King's Laws are considered to be wantonly in violation, special Complications may be distributed by King's will alongside the regular list of Impacts.

Minor Complications:

- Arrest one of the wizard's Companions. They cannot provide their care until the wizard retrieves them.
- Appoint a magistrate to monitor the wizard's Domain. Create an **Errant Lady** (page XXXX) from the King's Clan in that Domain.
- Levy a fine against the offending wizard. He must schedule and spend Time to pay that fine, changing the Lore of his Sanctum to reflect the loss of wealth, and if he doesn't he will take a Major Complication.

Major Complications:

- Arrest the wizard. He cannot spend Time in his Domain until he escapes.
- The wizard's Isle or Sanctum is attacked by the King's guards. Place an **Army** (page XXXX) in his Domain.
- One of the wizard's Companions is murdered by the King's guards.
- The King demands the offending wizard's death. If you fail to kill the wizard by the end of the month, the Court will be outraged — you cannot spend Time on anything related

to the Court, unless it's to kill a noble, until either the King is happy or there's a new King.

Part V: Denizens of the Court

Your control over the court is infamous, all those who consider themselves loyal to the King know to fear and respect your presence. And yet there are those who even now challenge your authority, those who work within and outside the Kingdom to orchestrate your downfall. While at times they may be helpful, you must stand eternally vigilant, for at any moment they may prove your undoing.

Within this Part of *The Book of Thrones*, you will learn the rules for Errant Nobles and Armies, and how they may both be leveraged to help and hinder the Pact.

Errant Ladies

An Errant Lady is a noblewoman who has either rejected the authority of the Kingdom of Isha or the centrality of the Court and has wandered away from the Warlock's own Domain to gain power and fame outside the traditional structures of Isha.

Creating an Errant Noble

Errant Ladies have their own heraldry (either matching their Clan or of their own design) and have their own personality quirk, either determined randomly, through the house containing **Mars** (♂), or selected.

Sign (☉)	Personality Quirk (♂)
Aries	Never backs down from a duel.
Taurus	Fond of animals, keeps many rare creatures.
Gemini	Leads a second life as a different

Sign (☉)	Personality Quirk (♂)
	gender or with a different family.
Cancer	Excessively maudlin, fond of romance novels.
Leo	Appreciates the work of any artist willing to satiate their ego.
Virgo	Fastidious to a fault, extremely clean.
Libra	Adores bureaucracy and decorum.
Scorpio	Easily exhausted, frequently rests.
Sagittarius	Flies into a rage at the slightest provocation.
Capricorn	Paranoid and nocturnal, avoids daylight hours.
Aquarius	Collects rare and valuable books on forbidden knowledge.
Pisces	Tormented by dreams and visions of other lands.

Errant Nobles and Other Roles [box]

An Errant Noble in a Domain may also be a Ghoul-Caller, an Occultist, a Beast, a Prophet, or any other Denizen of that Domain. When this occurs, work with the rest of the Celestial Audience to implement both as that same character.

Errant Nobles In Play

Ladies seek governance and command over a portion of the world. When they arrive in a Domain , they take charge of one of the components of that Domain. What this means exactly can vary based on the Domain:

- In the Necromancer's Domain, a Lady may lay claim to one of the spaces in the Edge of Life.
- In the Hierophant's Domain, a Lady may lay claim to a Temple.
- In the Mariner's Domain, a Lady may lay claim to a Sea or Beast.
- In the Faustian's Domain, a Lady may lay claim to a Community.
- In the Sage's Domain, a Lady may lay claim to a portion of the Dreamscape.
- In the Sorcerer's Domain, a Lady may lay claim to a Research Position or the Tower itself.

No one may schedule or spend Time on that portion of the Domain, as it is under the Lady's governance.

Errant Ladies maintain their own households. During the Visions Phase of each month, the Lady performs one of the following acts:

- If the Lady lacks Authority, she moves one Authority from the King to herself and gives a Gift to her portion of the Domain she occupies.
- If the Lady has Authority, she moves it to any Ideology and moves a random Lord from any Clan to herself. Then, add each of her Lords to the Agenda.

Armies

An army rallied is a hungry monstrosity, turning everything in its wake into fuel and food to keep pressing forward. Armies are huge — the King of Isha has a single Army, and each Clan can rally an Army when forced.

Armies In Domains

Armies occupy a specific Domain and will only rarely move from one Domain to another. While an Army occupies a Domain, Time cannot be scheduled or spent in that Domain.

Armies possess Favor and Authority, which together determines the power of the Army. If the Army is operating on behalf of a Clan, its Favor is equal to the Clan's Favor and its Authority is equal to Aristocracy's Authority. During the Quiet Phase of each month, roll a number of dice equal to 1 + the Army's Favor, of a size equal to the Army's Authority. If an Army has no Favor and no Authority, it dissolves.

- **If the Army has 0 Authority**, roll d6s.
- **If the Army has 1-3 Authority**, roll d8s.
- **If the Army has 4+ Authority**, roll d10s.

Then, for each Glyph, determine the Army's Impact:

- ⊖ The Army makes a fool of itself, misplacing resources or losing an important battle. *Remove half of all Authority and Favor from this Army and place it on another Army. If there is no other Army, it instead dissolves. Create a major Complication for this Army's Domain.*
- 2I The Army assists its Domain with logistics and resources. *Give the Domain a minor Gift. The Army gains +1 Favor.*
- ♂ The Army decisively strikes against another military power. *Remove half of all Authority from another Army and place it on this Army. If there is no other Army, create a major Complication for any other Domain.*
- ♀ The Army forages for resources from its Domain. *Give the Domain a minor Complication. The Army gains +3 Favor.*
- ♀ The Army mobilizes quickly, routing its enemies. *Move all Favor from another Army onto this Army. If there is no other Army, instead create a major Complication for this Army's Domain.*
- ☾ The Army gains allies from unlikely causes. *Move 2 Authority from any Ideology onto this Army. If you cannot, instead move 2 Authority from the King onto this Army.*
- h The Army causes horrific violence and death in its wake. *Destroy another Army entirely. If there is no other Army, instead create a Complication for every other wizard.*
- Ψ The Army claims authority over its territory. *The Army aligns itself with an Ideology. All Authority and Favor on the Army counts towards that Ideology for the purposes of determining who Truly Rules Isha.*

Anyone may schedule Time on an Army to assist or repress them. Spend that Time to move up to 2 of a combination of Favor and Authority from any Clan or Ideology onto the Army, or from the Army onto the King.

Wizards And Armies [box]

A wizard may rally an Army to serve their will during play, either through mundane or magical means. Determine how much Favor and Authority that Army possesses when it's created, moving Authority from Ergoism onto the Army.

Heroes

Most warriors fashion themselves to be the great men of the world, slayers of dragons, saviors of the meek. The truth is that they are just grist for the mill of history, ground into dust and forgotten as easily as the next man rises up to take his place. Those few who fashion themselves Heroes have been chosen by the great powers of the world to usher in a new age. They are blessed by the stars, their arc twisting towards justice — or darkness. Heroes may be as small as a local chieftain or knight, or the great boy-king Elpenor himself.

Whenever a member of the Pact encounters a warrior, consult with the Celestial Audience to determine if they're a proper Hero. Heroes must meet all of the following criteria:

- A Hero is a champion of a group of people or social identity, and is popular with that group.
- A Hero doesn't wield magic, and cannot cast spells of any Import.
- A Hero wields a magical weapon, gifted to them by a powerful force.
- The gods, the stars, the winds, or the Pact itself are rooting for the Hero to have a dramatic fate.

If the Hero doesn't match all of these criteria, they lack any special rules and function the same as any other Denizen. However if they are a Hero, then they carry with them a Magical Weapon and Titles of your choice. Determine the Fame of the Hero. Create the Magical Weapon using the *Construction of Magical Weapons* Spell on page XXXX of *The Grimoire*.

Heroic Importance

Heroes of **Local** Fame are the town's champion, the king's greatest knight, or the chieftain of a band of Hrotingmen. They have 1 Magical Weapon and 1-2 Heroic Titles. Heroes of **Great** Fame are the champions of a Foreign Power (such as the Triarchy of Ur), or a famed adventurer who

has explored the Faraway Sea. They have 1 Magical Weapon, 1 other Treasure, and 2-3 Heroic Titles. Heroes of **Mythic** Fame are of the greatest stock the world can offer — Elpenor himself is one. They have 2 Magical Weapons, 1 other Treasure, and 3-4 Heroic Titles.

Heroic Titles

Each Heroic Title is associated with one of the arcane Glyphs. Whenever a Spell is cast against a Hero, they can invoke their Titles to negate the first of each Glyphs. This is similar to a Ward. Multiple of the same Glyphs within a Spell cannot be negated.

- ⌘ A Title based on the Hero's humbleness, compassion, or common roots.
- ♂ A Title based on the Hero's physical prowess, might, or mastery of the battlefield.
- ♀ A Title based on the Hero's attractiveness, beauty, or stunning appearance.
- ♀ A Title based on the Hero's distance from home, the great lengths they have traveled, or the places they've been.
- ☾ A Title based on the Hero's wisdom, cunning, or intellect.
- ⌘ An insulting Title, earned by the Hero's participation in some horrendous tragedy or crime.
- ☿ A Title based on the Hero's similarity to another hero of yore, the support of the gods, or the blessing of the stars.

Heroes In Play

Every month a Hero is within a wizard's Domain, he must choose: take a minor Complication and move the Hero to another wizard's Domain (who must make the same choice again), or take a major Complication and leave the Hero in his Domain.

A Hero may only be removed through magic or through convincing them to give up their heroism and retire.

Part VI: Secrets of the Court

Beware, beware, the wicked schemes of mortal men! Although these petty lords may not wield the might of magic, their schemes are measured in seasons and years, and threaten to outpace and outstrip the rule of wizards. They cannot be allowed to rule absolutely. But what makes us think we're better than them?

Within this Part of *The Book of Thrones* you will learn the secrets of the Noble Clans of Isha and of the various powers outside the Archipelago.

Strange Tidings In The Court

Civil War

Civil War is a disastrous event, an exhausting pain for the wizards of the Pact, and represents the dissolution of the Warlock's control over his own Kingdom.

When A Wizard Becomes King

While it would certainly be a violation of Pact-Law for any other Wizard to become the King of Isha, there is no specific language against the Warlock becoming King. In that event, the Warlock must build his court and construct his zodiac just as he would any other inheritance, and when the Zodiac prompts his mood he must follow his mood. While the title of king may offer many benedictions, it is also a heavy burden, and such a wizard would soon find himself with many masters, and many new obligations beyond what he might be used to, for he is now partially at the whims of the stars themselves.

When The King is not a King

The crown does not always rest upon the head of a king. Revolution, invading empire, or dark magic may result in the installation of some other force as monarch of Isha. When this occurs, the Court continues much as it always has, although some adjustments may be necessary.

For instance, if the King's power is now held by a Parliament of Nobles, perhaps the Prime Minister (chosen by the Clan with the most Nobles) determines the Sun Sign and the Opposition determines the Moon Sign. Perhaps if the King's power is now held by the marketplace, what matters instead are shares in various business ventures, or in a base accumulation of wealth.

When such an event occurs, it is in your hands to determine how this new governing body functions, and how radically it departs from the courts of before. If the resulting creation is unbalanced or alien (as it so often is), in some senses this is a relief — a useful justification for restoring Monarchy to Isha.

The Noble Clans

The Uroch Clan

Whenever you spend Time meeting with Clan Uroch, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- The Urochi are amongst the most respected clans, composed of a recent union between two families. The clan involves itself in every step of mining, quarrying, construction, and smithing.
- The Uroch fashion themselves strong sculptors and masons, building the monumental works of Isha and carving its legacy. Among the craftsmen of Isha, the Urochi function as a trade guild, representing their interests politically but charging hefty dues for their iconography and legitimacy.
- The symbol of the Uroch Clan is a stylized crab, which is used as a stamp on pieces of silver or at the foot of old buildings to indicate their authenticity and worth.

The Lark Clan

Whenever you spend Time meeting with Clan Lark, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- The Lark Clan is amongst the oldest clans, founded by the mudlark families who would dive beneath the waves to collect treasures from the ruined towers on Isha's sea floor.
- The Larks fashion themselves guardians against piracy and eccentric treasure hunters. To the fishermen of Isha, they're seen as a necessary evil — they keep the pirates at bay

and grant access to the secrets of the deep, but their tithes are almost as high as the pirates would steal.

- The symbol of the Lark Clan is a bird's wing, and is a common motif on many ship's sails to prove to the Lark's army that they have paid their dues and deserve protection.

The Caravel Clan

Whenever you spend Time meeting with Clan Caravel, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- The Caravel Clan is the most sacred and powerful clan in Isha, for they are the inheritors of the sacred art of shipwrighting, and maintain the finest groves in the Halcyon Isles, whose only function is to prepare the most perfectly-constructed ships.
- The Caravels fashion themselves noble craftsmen of a near-forgotten artistry, of wizards in their own right whose magic is to bring life to dead wood and tie the isles together. To many in Isha they are a relic of a bygone age, their power more from their political machinations than from their work.
- The symbol of the Caravel Clan is a dragon, and it is illegal for any Ishanian-born captain to lead a ship without that authorized sigil carved somewhere on its hull.

The Waine Clan

Whenever you spend Time meeting with Clan Waine, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- Clan Waine is the most mysterious of the nobility, with countless rumors swirling around their foundation, with some claiming they were founded by a cult who cheated death itself. The clan itself only encourages the rumors, lending an air of mystique to the family.
- The Waine fashion themselves the sin-eaters of Isha, who carry the dead and dying to the Graven Isle and who perform surgery on the injured. The truth is an open secret: many in their ranks practice ghoulish calling and other illegal magics, and make their true fortune on smuggling occult treatises and reagents through their Auction House.
- The symbol of the Waine is a mangy dog, which they fly upon their black ships to warn other sailors of the dead they ferry to the Graven Isle.

The Ix Clan

Whenever you spend Time meeting with Clan Ix, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- Clan Ix is the most established family in Isha, capable of tracing their lineage back five hundred years before the Tragedies, and who are said to have been founded by the inventor of the twin writing systems used by Isha to this day.
- Ixians fashion themselves the great history-keepers of Isha, the authors of its past and the architects of its future. The common folk fear them as lawyers, bureaucrats, and authoritarian busybodies who inflate the ranks of the University, but who are valuable when literacy is needed.
- The symbol of the Ix is a gulabi goat, and the sacred herds of this animal are bred by the Ix's servants within the Halcyon Isles for their exquisite vellum.

Foreign Powers

The Triarchy of Ur

Whenever you Spend Time learning about the Triarchy of Ur, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- *The King's Historian says:* The Triarchy of Ur rules over much of the known world, an ancient empire based out of the sprawling megalopolis of Ur, so enormous it must be divided amongst three emperors (who are corrupt, childish, and rotting away, in turn).
- *The Admiral says:* Ur has, at various points, attempted to seize control of Isha and turn its magic towards their own ends. The Bone-Priests of Ur are jealous of Ishanian magic, and desire nothing more than to reclaim their lost glory.
- *The Diplomat says:* While Ur is a dying empire, they are not dead yet — a thousand different armies march under their banners, and their emperors can procure wealth beyond any's wildest dreams. If one could wrangle the full attention of Ur towards a single objective, then nothing could stand in its way.

Elpenor's Kingdom

Whenever you Spend Time learning about Elpenor's Kingdom, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- *The King's Historian says:* The Hecares Archipelago are a small southern nation, not dissimilar from Isha, which was conquered by Ur long ago. The boy-king Elpenor recently beat back the Urite armies and declared both his independence and his intent at expanding his kingdom northward.
- *The Admiral says:* While Elpenor's greatest foe is Ur, he has no lost love for wizards, for he blames magic for the death of his mother. Elpenor's oracles and advisors whisper in his ear even now encouraging him to seize Isha's power to aid in his expansion.
- *The Diplomat says:* Elpenor's Kingdom is new and ambitious, rapidly expanding across a large amount of territory and carving a name for itself in the history books. An alliance with Elpenor could give Isha access to this newfound power, and ensure its survival against Ur's inevitable wrath.

The Hrotingmen

Whenever you Spend Time learning about the Hrotingmen, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- *The King's Historian says:* The Hrotingmen come from a land of ice and snow far to the north, where they worship god-corpses and serve cruel witches, to raid and pillage Isha, dragging the archipelago's wealth back to their homes as bounty.
- *The Admiral says:* The Hrotingmen are Isha's longest enemy, whose Jarls have delighted in its torment and when united enough to launch an attack, have nearly torched the kingdom to the ground.
- *The Diplomat says:* An alliance with the Hrotingmen is both fickle and irresponsible, for they are warriors above all else, and lack any other culture. But their violence could be a valuable tool, if one could use it.

The Druj-Lands

Whenever you Spend Time learning about the Druj-Lands, you may also change or add to its Lore.

- *The King's Historian says:* The Drujmen are from a faraway land, poisoned by old necromancy that seeped into their bones. Now they cannot die, and they dwell in spider-fortresses wearing the mockeries of life and dreaming of stealing the truth of death.
- *The Admiral says:* The Drujites blame Wizards for their state, and many Necromancers have taken it upon themselves to travel West to eradicate these abominations of life, leading to miserable and haunting war.
- *The Diplomat says:* The Druj-Lands are the home to many forgotten relics from the Tragedies, as well as occult tomes holding twisted secrets of old magic. Obtaining these resources could make an alliance with the Druj worth tolerating.

Appendix

Names for Nobility

Men's Names

1. Larnie
2. Casien
3. Esidon
4. Arnett
5. Berdain
6. Essin
7. Burdoff
8. Cerdic
9. Hebbert
10. Beaugriad
11. Moriot
12. Hotario
13. Euchest
14. Lyandash
15. Adaben
16. Everick
17. Aurith

18. Jeroth
19. Corlenius
20. Doskar

Women's Names

1. Alemia
2. Brinnate
3. Abarella
4. Beatrin
5. Malita
6. Elemetry
7. Percilly
8. Ovilia
9. Ashouna
10. Lannech
11. Corledia
12. Dalliena
13. Dopphen
14. Niolle
15. Dollanetta
16. Iyomon
17. Hennel
18. Jonnava
19. Ibasella
20. Memiya

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